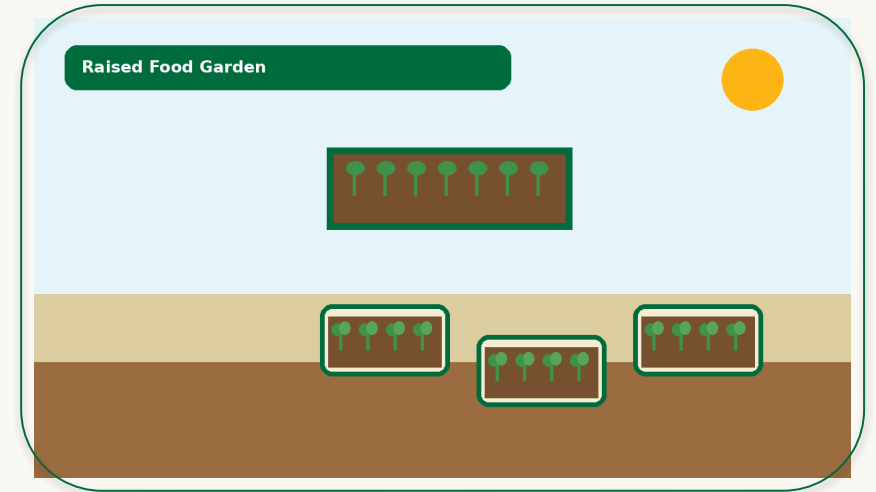


Raised Food Garden

Fundamentals of Food Growing

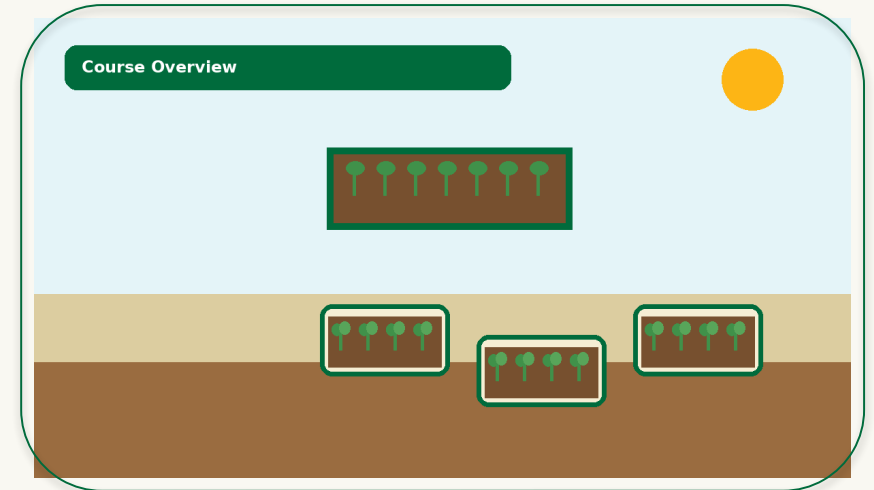
- LIFEWS AgriShine™ GrowMeal™ Primary 1-3 Teacher Training
- Audience: Primary 1-3 teachers, teaching assistants and garden facilitators
- Format: Self-paced online course + supervised practical orientation
- Recommended duration: 3 hours online + 60-90 minutes garden practical



Course Overview

Learning outcomes, materials and teacher readiness

- Learning outcomes: explain the garden's educational and production purpose; teach the ten course topics accurately; connect practical gardening to Primary 1-3 curriculum; supervise age-appropriate garden work; maintain simple records; assess learning through practical and classroom evidence.
- Core materials: teacher guide, crop/word/number cards as relevant, child-safe hand tools, watering equipment, labels, clipboards, rulers/measuring tools where relevant, observation/record sheets, clean harvest containers, handwashing supplies and first-aid access.
- Completion expectation: complete all modules, demonstrate one safe garden lesson, and submit a short lesson/assessment plan.



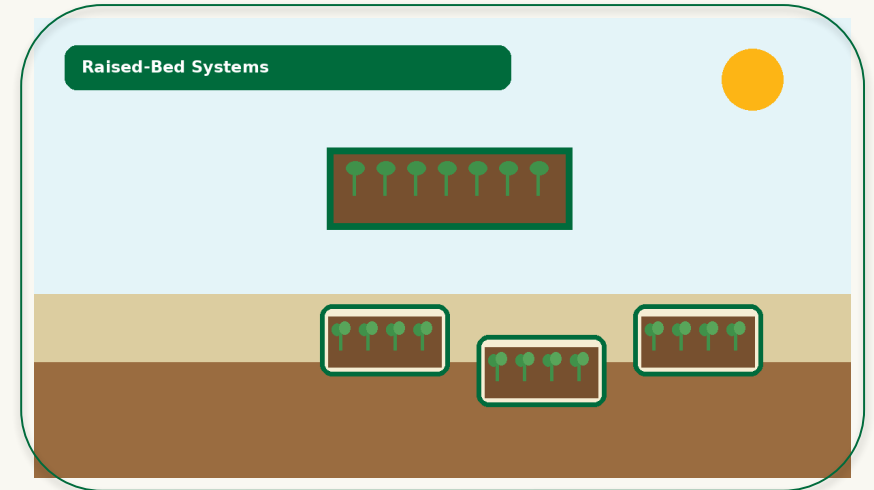
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Training sequence: EXPLAIN → DEMONSTRATE → PRACTISE → RECORD → REFLECT.

Raised-Bed Systems

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Explain the purpose of raised beds: defined growing space, managed soil and easier access where appropriately designed.
- Identify bed, path, soil surface and irrigation components.
- Teach pupils to stay on paths and out of beds.
- Discuss advantages without claiming raised beds are best for every site.
- Inspect structural stability before teaching.



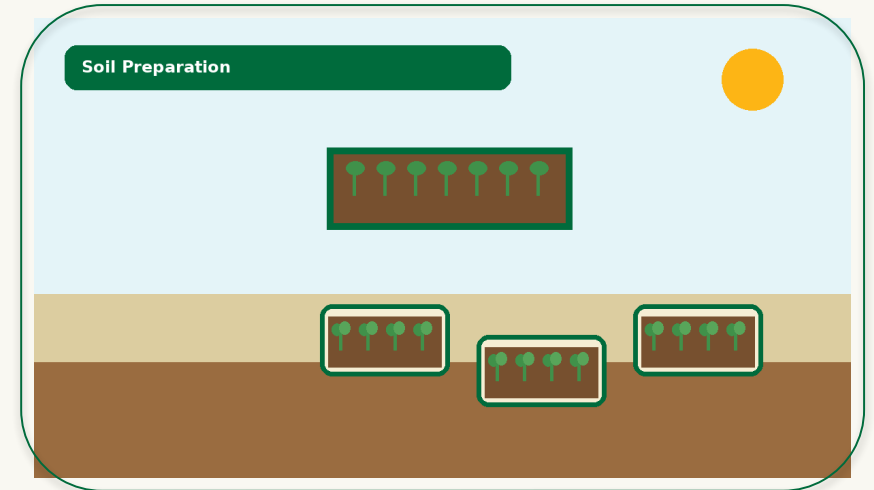
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare a labeled raised-bed orientation.

Soil Preparation

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Use clean garden soil/approved growing media and mature amendments according to the crop plan.
- Demonstrate loosening and leveling without excessive disturbance.
- Do not allow children to handle fresh manure or unknown amendments.
- Explain soil as the root-growing environment.
- Prepare beds before pupil planting if heavy work is required.



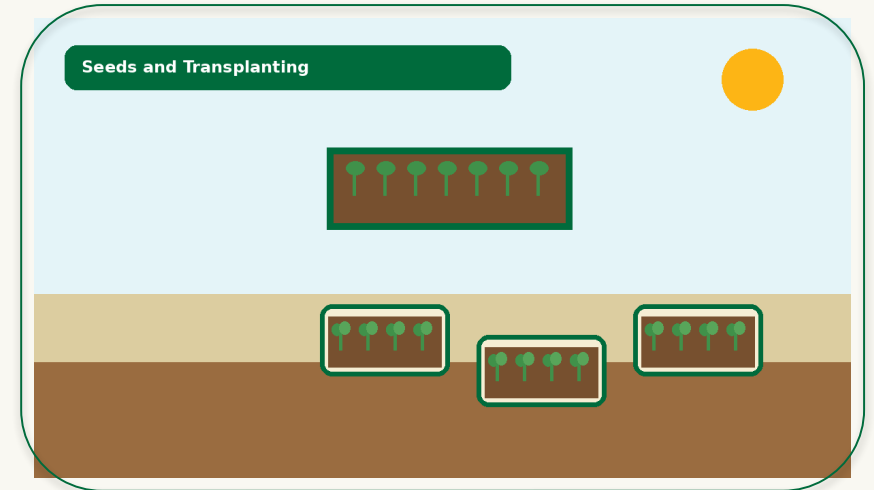
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Demonstrate a safe soil-preparation sequence.

Seeds and Transplanting

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Compare direct sowing with transplanting seedlings.
- Demonstrate planting depth and gentle root handling.
- Use viable seed and healthy seedlings.
- Label crop and planting date.
- Give pupils small, clearly defined planting sections.



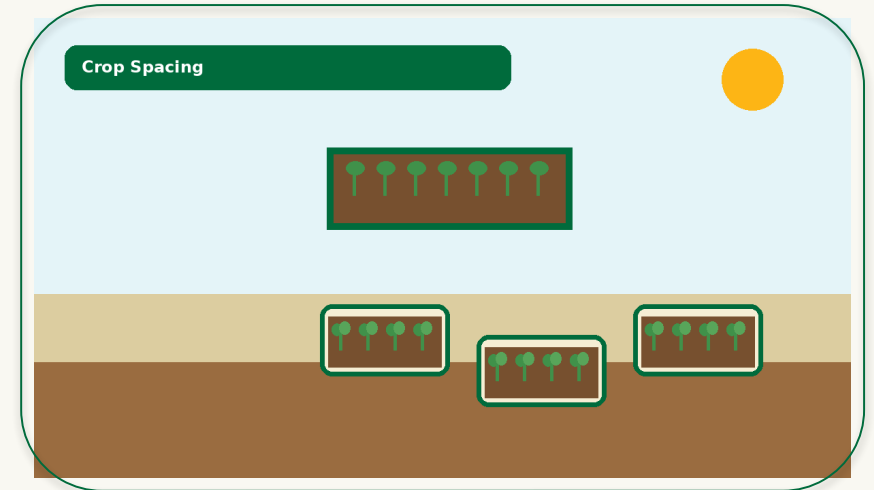
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare one sowing and one transplant demonstration.

Crop Spacing

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Explain spacing as room for roots, leaves, airflow and access.
- Use simple guides or marked lines.
- Follow crop-specific recommendations.
- Count plants after transplanting and correct obvious crowding early.
- Avoid using spacing only as a mathematics pattern.



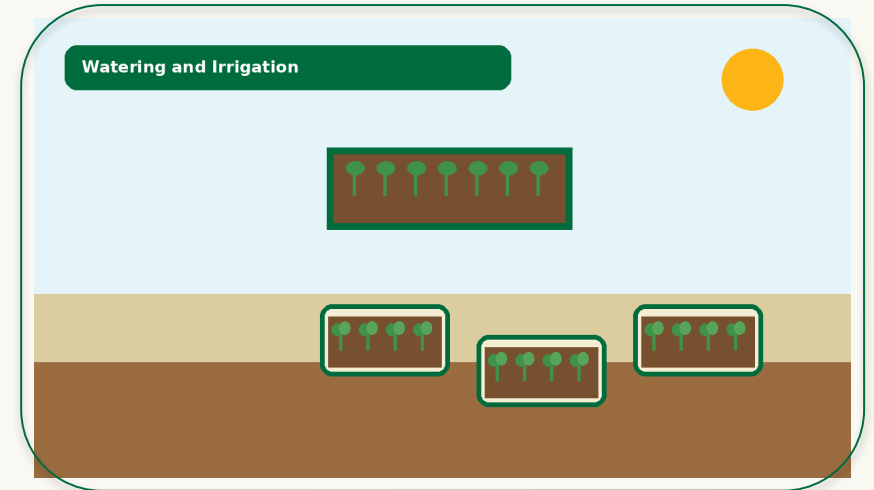
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare a spacing template for one crop.

Watering and Irrigation

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Show watering cans, drip lines or other installed systems.
- Water root zones appropriately and avoid unnecessary leaf wetting where crop management advises otherwise.
- Check soil moisture before watering.
- Teach that too much water can also harm plants.
- Keep irrigation equipment maintained and paths dry.



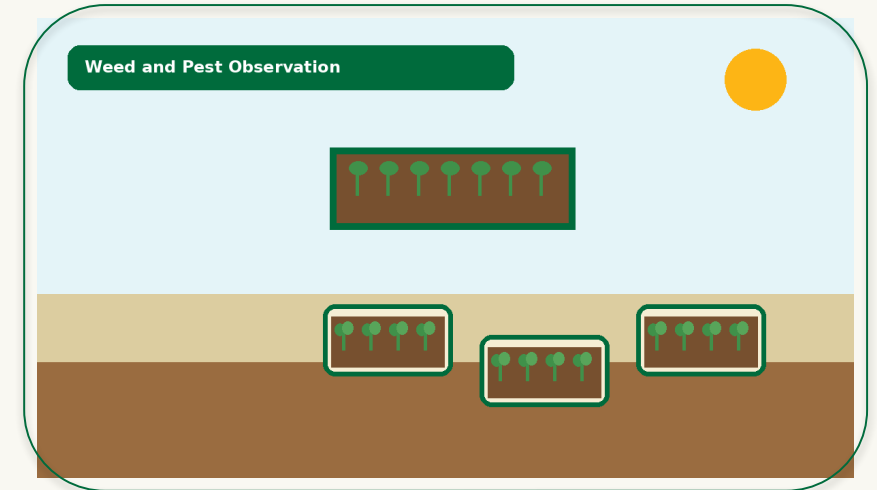
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Demonstrate a moisture-check and watering routine.

Weed and Pest Observation

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Teach pupils to identify teacher-confirmed weeds before removal.
- Observe pest damage without assuming every insect is harmful.
- Use simple records of holes, chewing or visible organisms.
- Pest-management actions follow the garden program; pupils should not handle pesticides.
- Encourage observation before intervention.



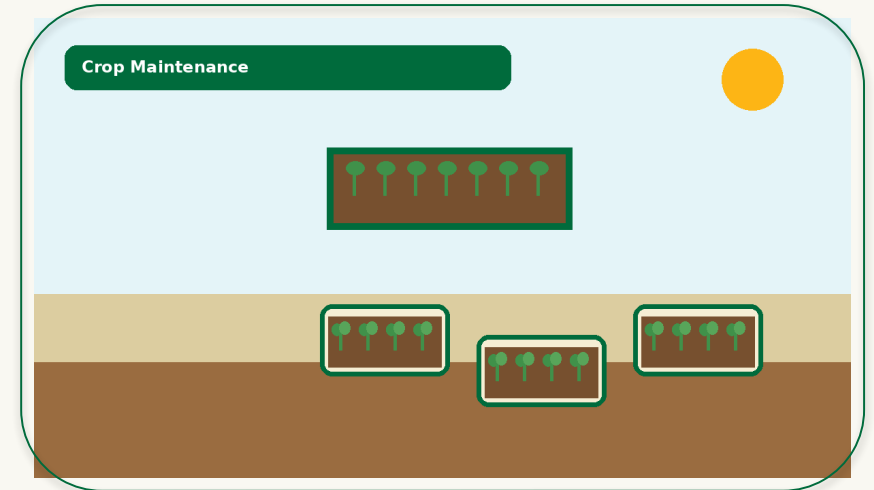
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare a weed-versus-crop identification check.

Crop Maintenance

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Combine watering, weeding, mulching, staking where appropriate and removal of damaged material.
- Assign age-appropriate tasks.
- Inspect tools before use.
- Keep labels and paths maintained.
- Record major care activities.



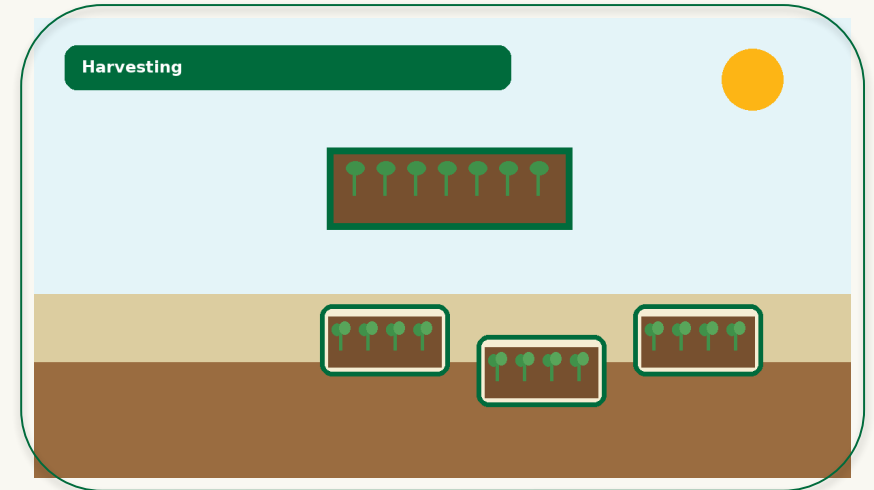
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Create a weekly raised-bed care rota.

Harvesting

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Identify crop-specific harvest readiness.
- Demonstrate correct picking or cutting method.
- Adults handle tools not approved for pupils.
- Harvest into clean containers.
- Record quantity and return residues to appropriate compost/waste streams.



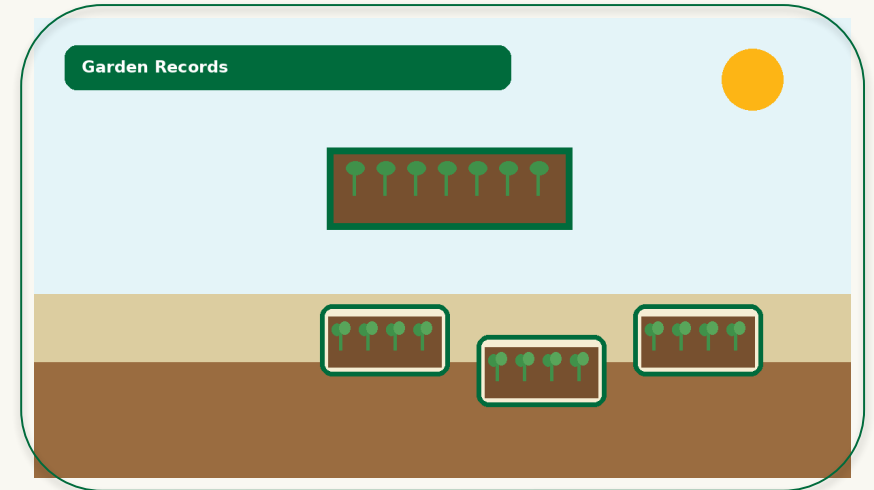
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare a safe harvest demonstration.

Garden Records

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Record crop, planting date, care activities, observations and harvest.
- Use simple tables or class charts.
- Keep units consistent for measurements.
- Use records to compare what happened across beds or dates.
- Separate observation from guesses.



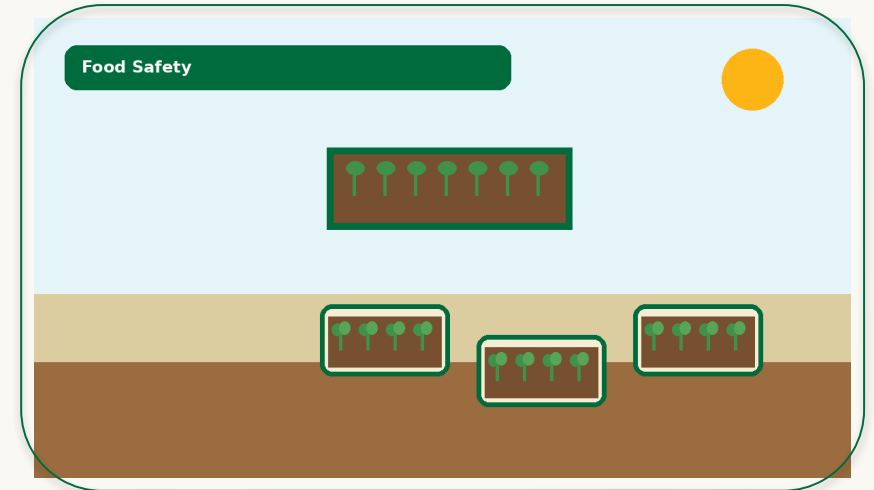
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Create a one-page raised-bed record.

Food Safety

Teacher knowledge and practical application

- Wash hands before handling ready-to-eat produce and after soil contact.
- Use clean harvest containers and potable water where washing is required.
- Keep produce away from chemicals, animal waste and dirty surfaces.
- Follow school allergy and food-service procedures.
- Do not eat garden produce unless the school has approved the activity.



TEACHER PRACTICE

- Completion task: plan a planting-to-harvest raised-bed lesson sequence.